# BRACING FOR A TRANSITION

## RIL BOARD



**MUKESH AMBANI,** 64
Chairman & MD

**EXECUTIVE DIRECTORS**

Nikhil R. Meswani
Hital R. Meswani
P.M.S. Prasad
Pawan Kumar Kapil

**NON-EXECUTIVE DIRECTORS**

Nita Ambani
Dipak C. Jain
R.A. Mashelkar
Adil Zainulbhai
R.S. Gujral
Shumeet Banerji
Arundhati Bhattacharya
K.V. Chowdary
Yasir O. Al-Rumayyan

## THE AMBANI SCIONS



**AKASH AMBANI,** 30
Director, Reliance Jio Infocomm and Reliance Retail Ventures



**ISHA AMBANI,** 30
Director, Reliance Jio Infocomm and Reliance Retail Ventures



**ANANT AMBANI,** 26
Director, Reliance New Energy Solar

## OTHER BUSINESS HEADS/ LEADERS

Industry veterans in the 50-65 age group

**DIGITAL SERVICES**

**SANJAY MASHRUWALA & MATHEW OOMMEN**
Presidents, Reliance Jio

**PANKAJ PAWAR**
Business Head, Jio

**OIL TO CHEMICALS**

**P.K. KAPIL**
Executive Director

**SANJIV SINGH**
Group President

**SRINIVAS TUTTAGUNTA**
Director

**RETAIL**

**SUBRAMANIAM V.**
MD, Reliance Retail

**AKHILESH PRASAD**
CEO, Reliance Trends

**DARSHAN MEHTA**
CEO, Reliance Brands

**BRIAN BADE**
CEO, Reliance Retail

**DAMODAR MALL**
President & CEO, food & grocery retail

**FINANCE**

**ALOK AGARWAL**
Group CFO

**SRIKANTH VENKATACHARI**
Group Joint CFO

## SOME FUTURE LEADERS

In the 35-50 age group, being groomed for bigger roles

**ANSHUMAN THAKUR**
Head of strategy, Reliance Jio

**KAUSHAL NEVREKAR**
Chief Business Officer, Reliance Digital

**SAURABH SANCHETI**
CFO, Jio Platforms

**RAJ MULICK**
Chief Accounts Officer, RIL

**ASHWIN KHASGIWALA**
CFO, Reliance Retail

**KIRAN THOMAS**
President, Jio

**SANJAY ROY**
Head, deepwater oil & gasfields assets

**ASHISH LODHA & AAYUSH BHATNAGAR**
Senior V-Ps, Jio Platforms

**R. SRINIVASAN**
President-revenue and commercial operations, Jio

**SOUMYA DUTTA**
Head of treasury

children take over the RIL reins, supported by a mix of professionals and family loyalists. "I have no doubt that Akash, Isha and Anant, as the next-gen leaders, will lead Reliance to even greater heights," he said.

Ambani may have ideally wanted to give more time to his children to learn the ropes, but for an impending deadline set by market regulator Sebi that companies should split their chairman and managing director positions by April 2022, to enable greater transparency and accountability. While it is not clear yet how the leadership positions would be divided, RIL sources say Ambani, post the transition, intends to focus on Reliance Foundation's work.

When Ambani took over as CMD, RIL had a gross turnover of Rs 65,061 crore and a net profit of Rs 4,104 crore. Much has changed since then. From an industrial giant largely dependent on petrochemicals, RIL made three major diversifications over the years—first into oil and gas, and then into consumer-focused businesses such as retail and, most recently, telecom. This transition enabled it to multiply its revenues eight times over and post a net profit of Rs 53,739 crore in 2020-21.

RIL had a market capitalisation of Rs 16.25 lakh crore as on December 29, 2021, the highest among Indian companies. "Mukesh Ambani is doing the right thing for a systematic, structured succession at RIL. One should be willing to move on. You are responsible towards stakeholders, not shareholders or the family," says Prof. Kavil Ramachandran of the Indian School of Business, Hyderabad, adding that the Ambani scions should earn their positions.

The next-generation Ambanis have been groomed for all the new-age businesses of the group—retail, digital, telecom and clean energy. Akash and Isha joined Reliance Jio Infocomm and Reliance Retail Ventures as directors at the age of 24. Isha, who graduated from Yale University with majors in psychology and South Asian studies in 2013, had a brief stint with McKinsey in the US. Akash, who graduated from Brown University with a major in

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